

A SMALL PIECE OF JARGON

What "fully decodable" actually means.

(And why the answer matters)

**"Fully decodable" sounds like a
yes/no label.**

It isn't.

A book is only "fully decodable" relative to a specific scope, a
specific student, and a specific point in the year.

A MORE HONEST FRAMING

"Decodable for a student who has been taught these patterns, plus this short list of high-frequency words."

Here's a way to think of it: decodability is a relationship, not a sticker.

**If your program's "decodable"
books include patterns your
students haven't been taught yet,
the books are unfair to your kids.**

(The same is true of assessment texts!)

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